



DRH - Color Ramp Studio

Professional User Manual · Version 1.1.0 · Blender 4.2+

Overview

DRH - Color Ramp Studio accelerates Color Ramp creation, sampling, conversion, editing, and reuse across Shader Editor, Geometry Nodes, and Compositor workflows. Version 1.1.0 focuses on color accuracy, preset discovery, safer sampling, conversion reliability, and a clearer generation workflow.

Product	DRH - Color Ramp Studio
Version	1.1.0
Blender	4.2 or later
Platforms	Windows, macOS, Linux
Primary location	Node Editor > Sidebar > DRH-Ramp Studio
Distribution	Official release through BlendKit
Support	GitHub Issues and Discussions

Quick start

- Install the current release through Blender using the downloaded extension ZIP.
- Open a Node Editor and show the sidebar.
- Open the DRH-Ramp Studio tab.
- Use Generate to prepare either a Color Sampler workflow or a Preset workflow.
- For Preset mode, choose the preset and use Generate Ramp when you are ready to apply it.
- Use conversion/editing utilities when a native Color Ramp needs deeper manipulation, then restore to a native ramp when required.

Preset discovery and generation

Version 1.1.0 reorganizes preset discovery around combinations of text search, category filtering, and color-family filtering. This makes it easier to narrow the library without manually scanning every preview.

Preset categories

- Trending
- Pastel
- Dark
- Vibrant
- Earthy
- Warm
- Cool
- Neutral
- Grayscale

Generate workflow

The Generator presents a deliberate choice between Color Sampler and Preset workflows. Preset mode creates a default native Color Ramp and does not apply a selected preset until Generate Ramp is used. New ramps are positioned at the center of the visible Node Editor canvas, helping avoid creation behind the sidebar.

Color accuracy

Preset hex values and screen/image sampling are treated as sRGB source colors. They are converted to linear RGB before assignment to Blender Color Ramps. Perceptual HSV-style operations run in sRGB space and return the result to linear RGB, avoiding display-oriented edits directly on linear channel values.

Sampling and image workflows

- Extract palettes from image files.
- Use screen-based gradient/color sampling for visual references.
- Merge similar neighboring stops when a sampled gradient contains unnecessary density.
- Use bounded pixel sampling for image palette extraction rather than materializing a complete image pixel buffer.
- Keep temporary image ownership isolated so existing user image datablocks are not removed by the add-on workflow.
- Use DRH ownership metadata on temporary sampler reference images.

Conversion and restoration

Native Color Ramp nodes can be converted into editable group-based workflows and later restored. Version 1.1.0 improves conversion cleanup so failed operations remove temporary generated data rather than leaving unwanted nodes or unused node-group datablocks.

- Convert native Color Ramps to editable group-based setups.
- Expose ramp controls through group inputs where applicable.
- Preserve restore data for returning to a native Color Ramp.
- Apply persistence only after a conversion is ready to commit.
- Read legacy 1.0 metadata for migration/restoration compatibility.

Ramp editing tools

- Copy and paste ramps.
- Redistribute, reverse, normalize, randomize, and nudge stop positions.
- Duplicate or de-duplicate midpoints.
- Simplify sampled stops and limit decimal precision.
- Set uniform alpha or create alpha gradients.
- Invert colors; sort by luminance or hue; mirror, shuffle, or rotate colors.
- Shift temperature, apply harmony modes, and shape value/color behavior for different visual styles.

Preferences and scene settings

Preferences define defaults. In 1.1.0, editing a preference no longer overwrites settings in every open scene. Existing scene-level values are preserved during registration. The context-menu preference remains an intentional immediate-update path.

Compatibility notes

- Blender 4.2 is the minimum supported version.
- The extension uses the Blender 4.2+ NodeTree.interface API and does not include unsupported pre-4.0 interface branches.
- Screen sampling depends on operating-system screen-capture support.
- Pure Wayland environments may require X11/XWayland for desktop capture.
- macOS may require Screen Recording permission for Blender.

Support and resources

Download	https://www.blendkit.com/asset-gallery-detail/62ac725e-c55e-4e26-9e39-f6b81432d962/
Support repository	https://github.com/pacosalasv/DRH_Color_Ramp_Studio-Support
Issues	https://github.com/pacosalasv/DRH_Color_Ramp_Studio-Support/issues
DRH catalog	https://www.blendkit.com/?query=author_id:205846
Paco Salas DRH	https://pacosalasv.blogspot.com/

When reporting a problem, include the exact Color Ramp Studio version, Blender version, operating system, clear reproduction steps, expected result, actual result, and safe evidence such as an error message or screenshot.

License

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